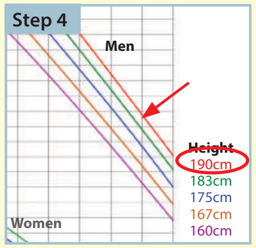
Calculate % of predicted PEFR

Calculate % of predicted PEFR to help provide routine asthma/COPD care
e.g. 60 year old man with asthma who is 188cm tall.

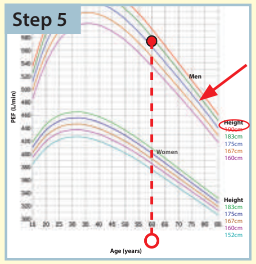
Step 1
Measure patient's PEFR ⮌ 123. Use the highest of 3 results - this is the 'observed PEFR'.
e.g. his PEFR readings are: 450; 420; 400. Use 450 as the 'observed PEFR'.

Step 2
Plot the patient on the adjacent PEFR graph using height, sex and age.



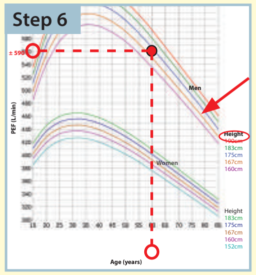
Step 3
If patient a man, look at group of lines next to 'Men'. If patient a woman, look at group of lines next to 'Women'.
e.g. this patient is a man, look at group of lines next to 'Men'.

Step 4
Identify the patient's height and choose the coloured line closest to that height.
e.g. this patient's height is 188cm, choose the red line.



Step 5
Identify the patient's age on the bottom axis and draw a line up until it meets the coloured height line identified in step 4.
e.g. this patient is 60 years old

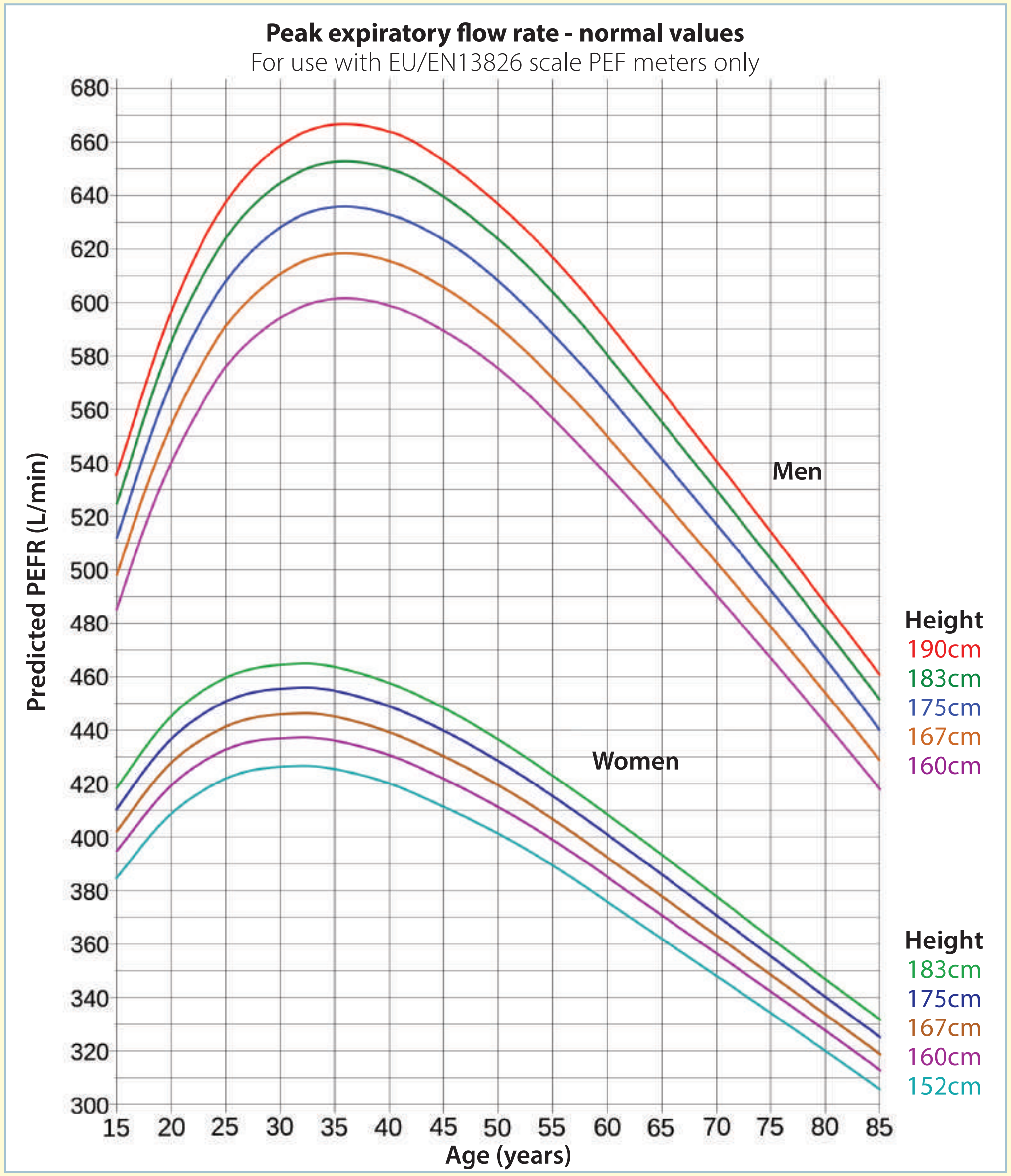
Step 6
From this point on the coloured line, draw a straight line left until you reach the left axis (labelled Predicted PEFR). The closest number is the 'predicted PEFR'.
e.g. this patient's 'predicted PEFR' is ± 590 L/min.



Step 7
Calculate % of predicted PEFR:
observed PEFR ÷ predicted PEFR x 100
e.g. 450 ÷ 590 x 100 = 76%.

Step 8
Interpret result:
- If known asthma and PEFR is < 80% of predicted, asthma is not controlled.
- If known COPD and PEFR is 50-80% of predicted PEFR, COPD is moderate. If PEFR is < 50% of predicted PEFR, COPD is severe.

e.g. this patient whose PEFR is 76% of his predicted PEF has asthma that is not controlled.



Adapted by Clement Clarke for use with EN13826 / EU scale peak flow meters from Nunn AJ Gregg I, Br Med J 1989:298;1068-70